

more features, Coleco managed to set the Telstar apart with its lower price of \$50, which brought about more widespread exposure for the system and led to its heavy demand.

Following the Telstar was the Color TV Game, created by Nintendo and marketed exclusively in Japan. Like a lot of the consoles before it, players controlled the paddles using dials attached to the machine. The machine had six different varieties of Pong, and each game could be played in a sin-



Coleco Telstar

gles or doubles mode. The extra game was “penalty shootout” where the goal is to shoot the ball past a constantly moving target.

Following models had many other games, such as racing games, hockey, volleyball and tennis. Considering the lack of consoles in Japan, the Color TV Game did quite well

there, selling three million units of the first four models. This model was the predecessor for the Game Boy that was produced by Nintendo later.

1977 ended with a bang, with Atari releasing its CPU-based console, called the Video Computer System (VCS), later called the Atari 2600. A little background on the production of the Atari 2600 would be fitting at this point: the release of the Channel F spurred Atari into action to hurry along development of their cartridge based console, out of fear of them losing out on the existing cartridge business, which would have allowed Fairchild to create a dominating presence.

When the Atari Video Computer System was released, it had better specs compared to the Channel F. With 256B of RAM compared to the Channel F’s measly 64B, a better performing 8-bit Motorola processor compared to the F’s F8, and a superior AI that allowed for higher versatility during the player vs computer matches, Atari VCS went on to sell more than 25 million units over its product life. The VCS was packaged along with two joystick controllers, paddle controllers and a game cartridge: the initial choice of Combat was later replaced by Pac-man. Atari continued to partner with Sears, and renamed its VCS as the Sears Video Arcade and sold it through Sears, Roebuck and Company stores.